



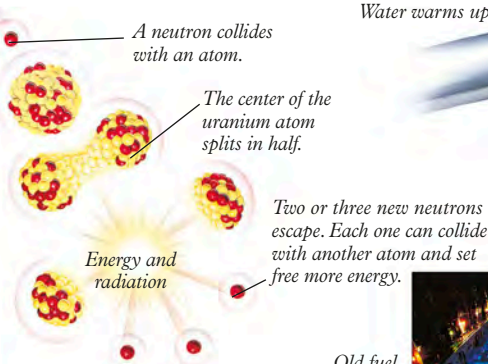
# NUCLEAR ENERGY



## Super fuel

One handful of pure uranium can release as much energy as 72,000 barrels of oil!

boil water. Steam from this hot water is used to generate electricity. People worry about nuclear power because when the energy is released from an atom, deadly rays, called radiation, also escape.



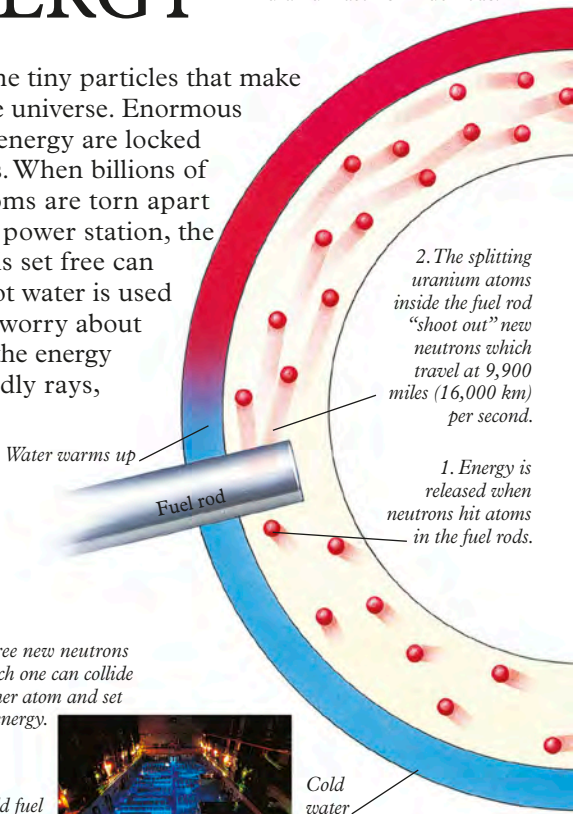
## Fission division

The heart of an atom, called a nucleus, is made up of neutrons and protons. These are held together by energy. When an atom is split, some of this energy is set free. Splitting an atom to release energy is called fission.



## Not so fast

This drawing shows very simply how neutrons whizz around a nuclear reactor and crash into uranium atoms in fuel rods.



Old fuel rods are radioactive "garbage."



## Cool it

Fuel rods are replaced every few years. Before the reusable uranium can be removed from them, the rods are cooled in a special pond.